Interplay

Connecting youth to the world of music

Clem, Nina, Olivia, and Ava

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Meet Our Team



Clementine Robertson



Marina Libman



Olivia Tanaka



Ava Lopez

Brief

Our project explores how design research can uncover the **social, cultural, and community impacts** of **music education** in New York City. Through studying music programs, nonprofit initiatives, and creative spaces, our **goal** is to **understand how access to music** shapes individuals and **strengthens community well-being.**

Social Impact

Music education empowers young people, builds confidence, and promotes mental wellness. **Nonprofits** help **bridge educational** and **economic gaps** by **providing** access to music lessons, instruments, and **mentorship.**

Cultural Accessibility

NYC's **diverse neighbourhoods** host schools, after-school programs, and community centers where **music connects people across cultures.** Access to these **opportunities** often **depends** on **funding, awareness, and community outreach.**

Creative Ecosystem

The city's music studios, venues, and **nonprofit initiative** **such as** **Save The Music, National Sawdust, and Jazz Foundation of America create pathways** for **artists** to grow, and **sustain their craft,** enriching NYC's cultural life.

We want **to learn how the people and programs** behind New York's music scene; schools, nonprofits, and local artists, can **help** more **New Yorkers discover the power of music and creativity.**

Initial Sketches

Idea exploration based on Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Olivia



Nina



Ava

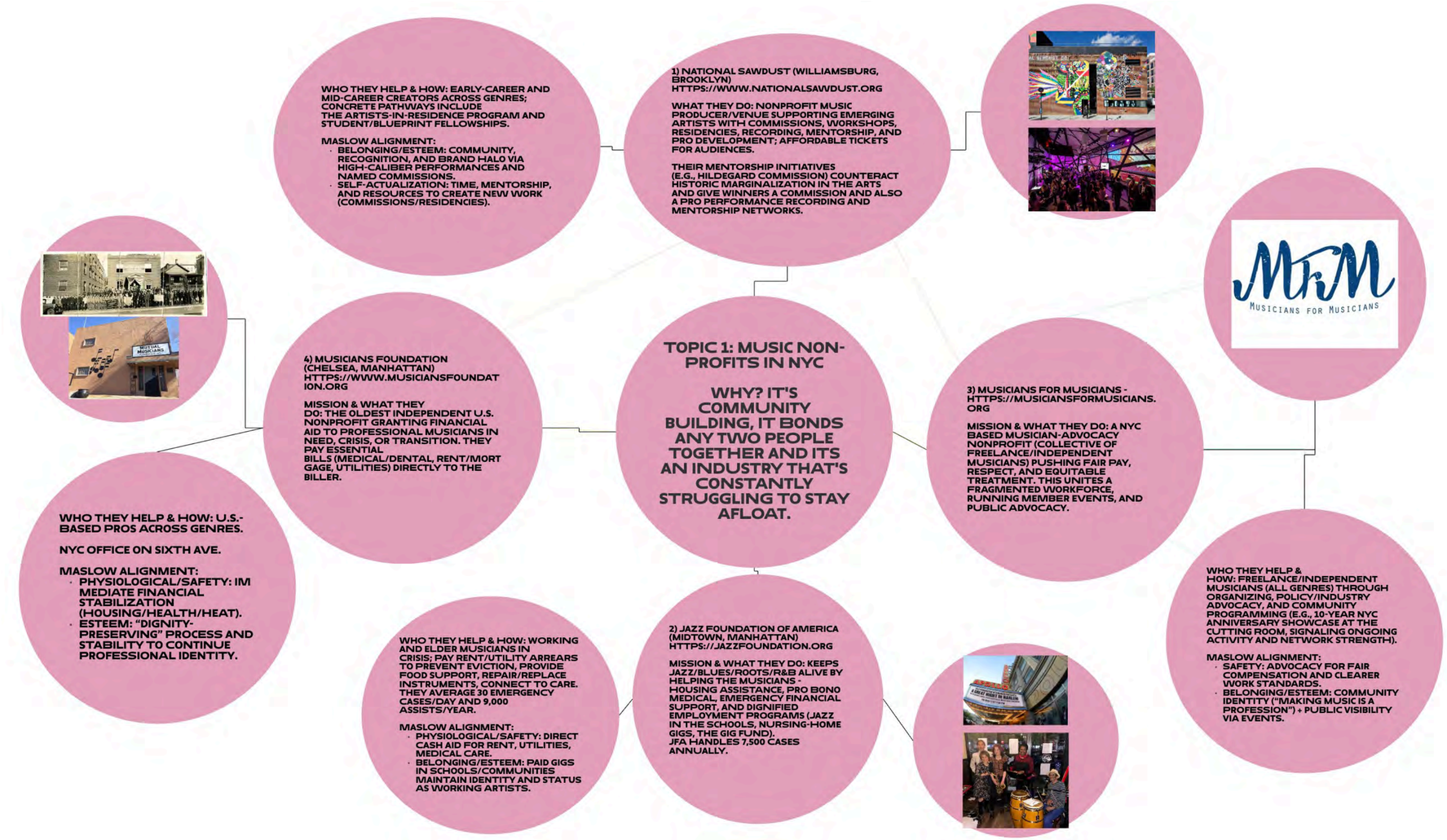


Clementine



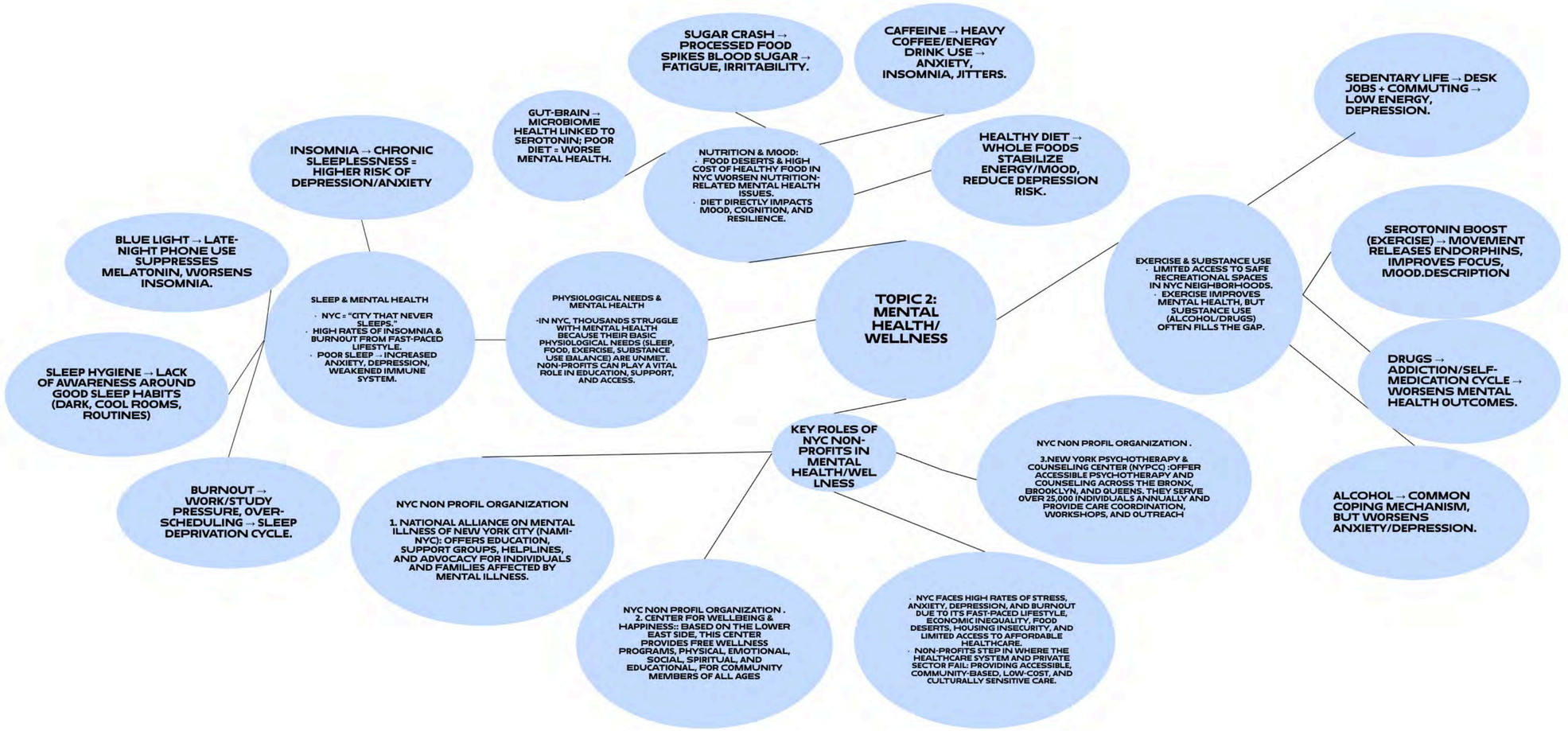
Initial Sketches

Music Non-Profits in NYC



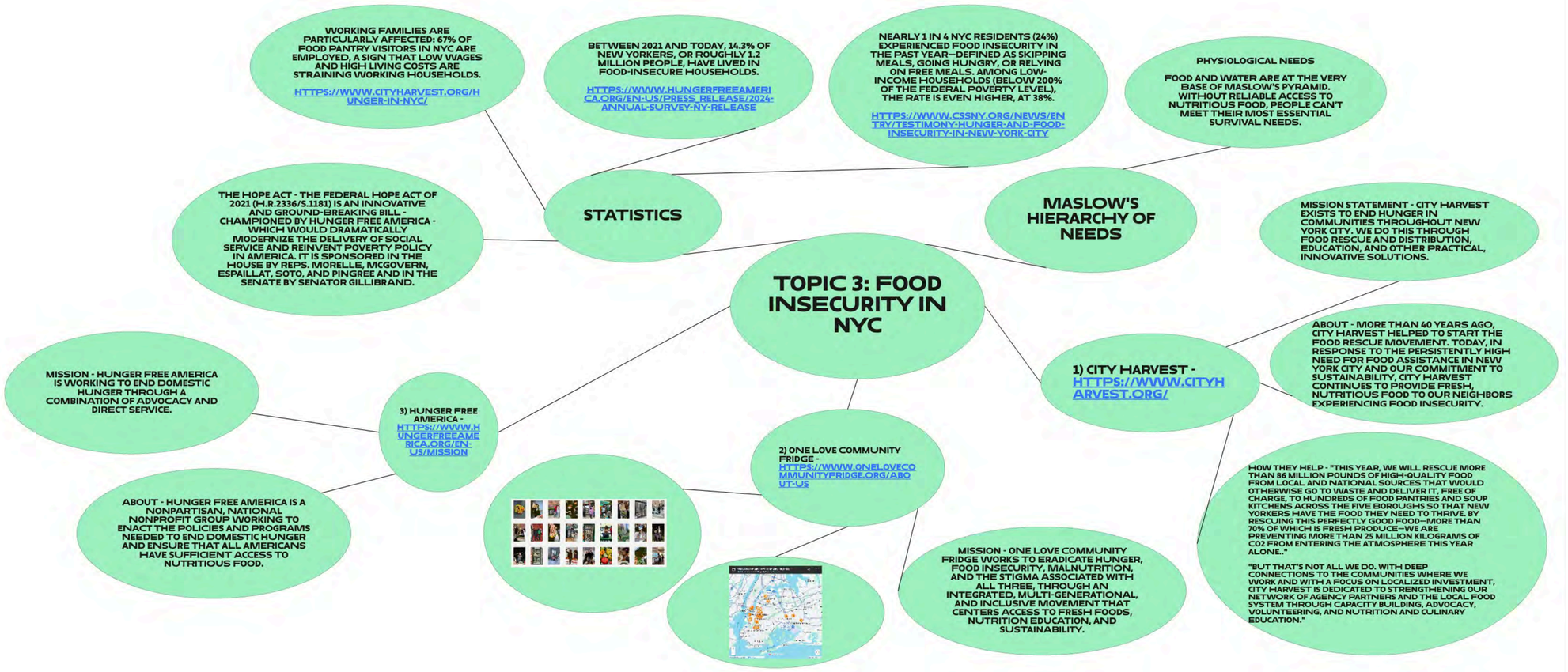
Initial Sketches

Mental Health/ Wellness



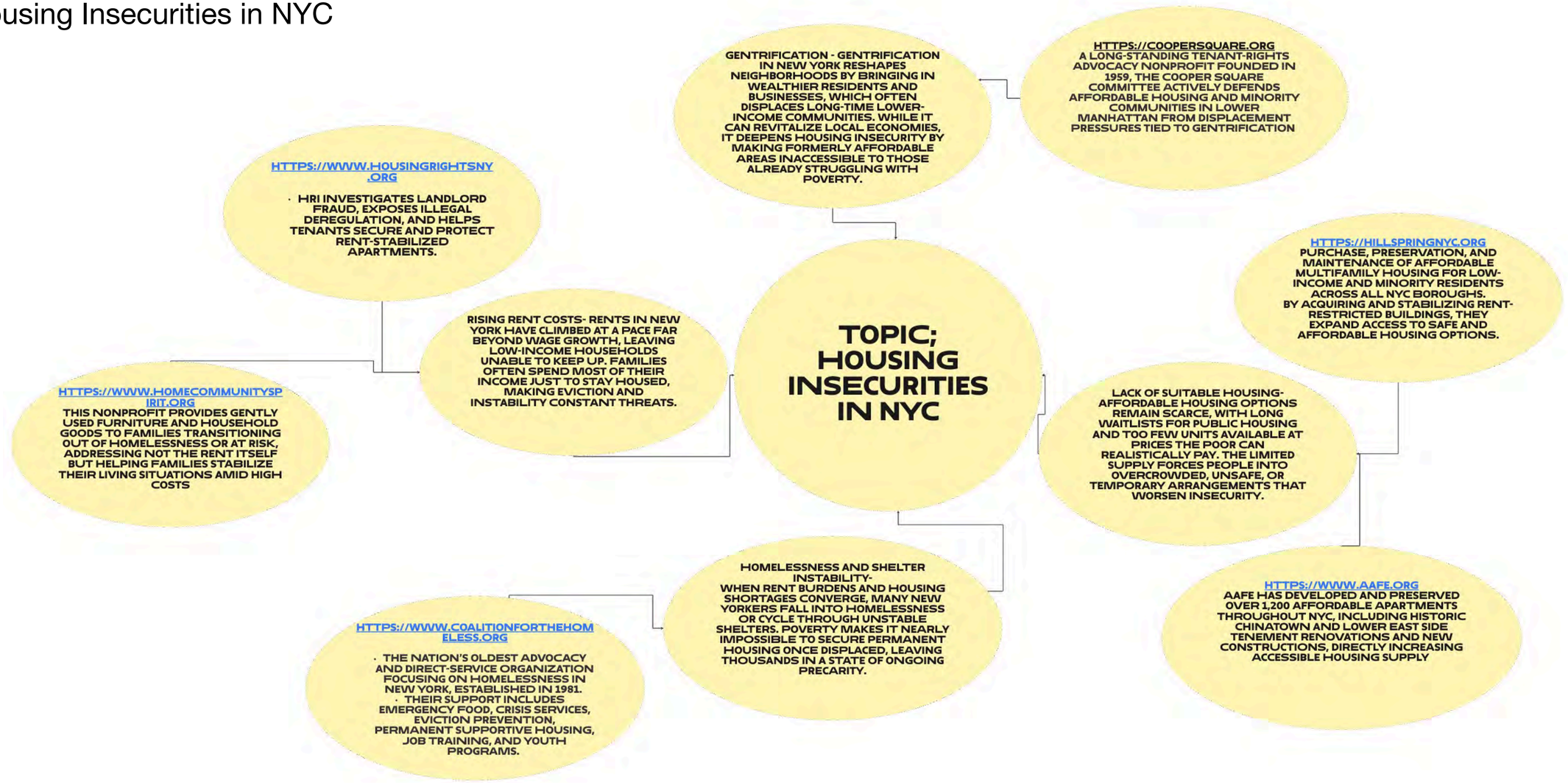
Initial Sketches

Food Insecurity in NYC



Initial Sketches

Housing Insecurities in NYC

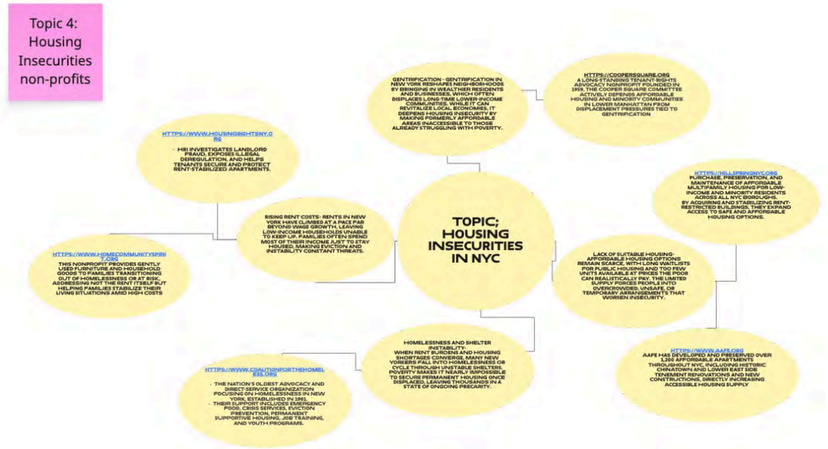


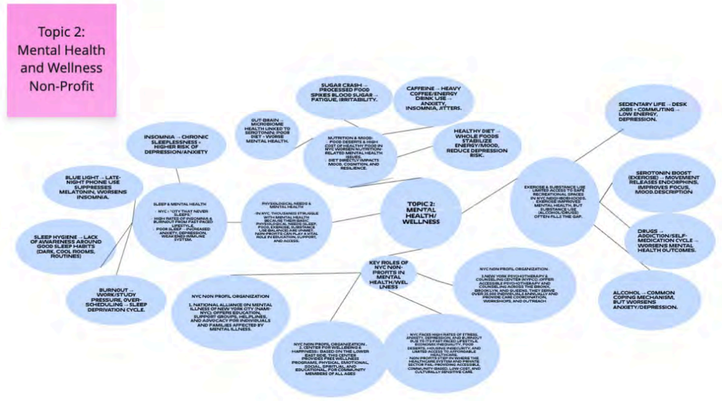
Initial Ideas

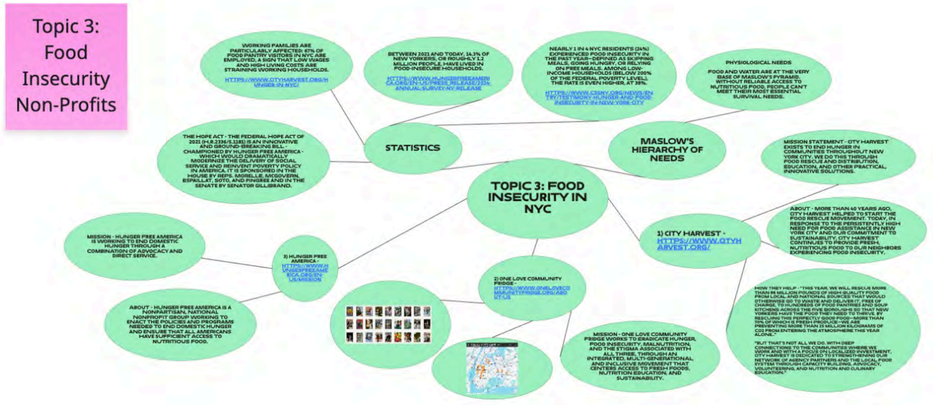
Four ideas to One

Everyone seemed to be enthusiastic about the research potential and the differences these ideas make, which would help finalize our decision to **Music Non-Profits NYC.**









Initial Ideas

Mental Health/Wellness

Why it matters to me?

Living in New York City, I feel how easy it is to get caught up in constant pressure to keep going. With that, wellness often gets pushed aside, when in reality it's the foundation for everything else: work, relationships, and personal growth.

Facts and Statistics

- In NYC, about one in five adults has symptoms of depression at any given time.
- The economic cost of poor mental health in the U.S. exceeds $200 billion annually due to lost productivity, absenteeism, and healthcare (CDC).

NYC Non-profit organizations

National Alliance on Mental Illness of New York City (NAMI-NYC): Offers education, support groups, helplines, and advocacy for individuals and families affected by mental illness.

Center for Wellbeing & Happiness: Based on the Lower East Side, this center provides free wellness programs, physical, emotional, social, spiritual, and educational, for community members of all ages.



Initial Ideas

HMW's

How might we increase access to mental health and wellness services for New Yorkers facing financial or cultural barriers?

How might we make mental health resources feel more approachable and less stigmatized in diverse NYC communities?

How might we integrate wellness into the daily lives of New Yorkers who are already under pressure from work and housing challenges?

Insight Statement

Life in NYC is stressful and wellness often gets pushed aside, so many people struggle to find affordable, approachable ways to take care of their mental health.

Initial Ideas

Food Insecurity

Why it matters to me?

Food insecurity is one of the most urgent challenges facing New York City. Access to affordable, nutritious food is the foundation of health and stability, yet many households struggle to meet this basic need. The problem is widespread but also deeply unequal, with less affluent neighborhoods carrying a far greater burden.

Facts and Statistics

- Between 2021 and today, **14.3% of New Yorkers** have lived in **food-insecure households**.
- Working families are particularly affected: **67% of food pantry visitors** in NYC are employed, a sign that low wages and high living costs are straining working households.

Opportunities/Impact Storytelling

- **Support initiatives** like community fridges, urban farms, and food rescue programs to strengthen food distribution networks.
- **Partnerships** between nonprofits, local businesses, and community groups.

Nonprofits

- **City Harvest:** food rescue and distribution, education, and other practical, innovative solutions.
- **One Love Community Fridge:** eradicate hunger, food insecurity, malnutrition, and the stigma associated with all three.
- **Hunger Free America:** national nonprofit group working to enact the policies and programs needed to end domestic hunger and ensure that all Americans have sufficient access to nutritious food.

Initial Ideas

HMW's

How might we make healthy food more affordable and accessible for New Yorkers dealing with rising food costs?

How might we create food systems in NYC that are more resilient against instability and scarcity?

How might we reduce the gap between food waste and food insecurity to feed more people reliably?

Insight Statement

Rising food prices and constant waste show that access and affordability decide if New Yorkers can eat well.

Initial Ideas

Music Non-Profits

Why it matters to me?

Measuring and sharing how residencies/ commissions change artists' income, visibility, and output **to attract future funders** as well as **getting scouted by labels** for their development.

Music matters to NYC:

The music industry supports **60,000 jobs, $5B in wages**, and **$21B in output,** and yet the workers and venues behind it remain economically vulnerable. That mismatch is why I want to work on this.

Facts and stats

The pandemic: NYC arts employment fell **60% in a single month (March to April 2020)** and recovery has been uneven.

Opportunities? Impact Storytelling



Initial Ideas

Music Non-Profits

Funding

Musicians need facilities to upkeep their practice.

Without benefits, musicians cannot devote dedicated time to music.

Education

Access to school music programs is not the same as **participation**: although 92% of students have access, only **48% participate**, showing a gap in engagement.

Nearly **four million U.S. students lack any music education at school**, which reduces the pipeline of future artists.

Venues

NYC **venues struggle to stay profitable,** limiting live performance opportunities for emerging artists.

Community events and **outreach** can strengthen ties between artists, audiences, and **donors.**

Data Synthesis

Statistics

Nonprofits Funding Artists (NYC)

Creative Capital has committed $50M+ in project funding since 1999. This shows how strong nonprofit support for artists.

Music Education (USA + NYC)

NYC requires certain arts/music instructional time: for example, in grades 1-3 = 20% of weekly time to arts subjects. Grades 4-6 = about 10%. Grades 7-8 = at least a half-unit of study in music and visual arts. Grades 9-12 = at least one full unit in the arts for graduation

Impacts to NYC

NYC invested $727M in cultural nonprofits - proving government recognition of arts' economic and social value.

Next Steps

Need to highlight inequality & success stories, reach out to emerging musicians and gather appropriate research methods.

Data Synthesis

Who is involved?

Musicians from all ages and any level, non-profit organizations in NYC, venues, donators, people in the industry who are willing to help and us!

Checklist of Points before Visual Synthesis:

- Music is important for community building and so needs to be accessible to all.
- Many artists don't need benefits but then struggle to make music because of lack of funding.
- The hours aren't structured making it hard to get a well paid side job.
- Rent in New York is at an all time high but is also a music hot spot which increases artist stress.



Data Synthesis



Music Non-Profits

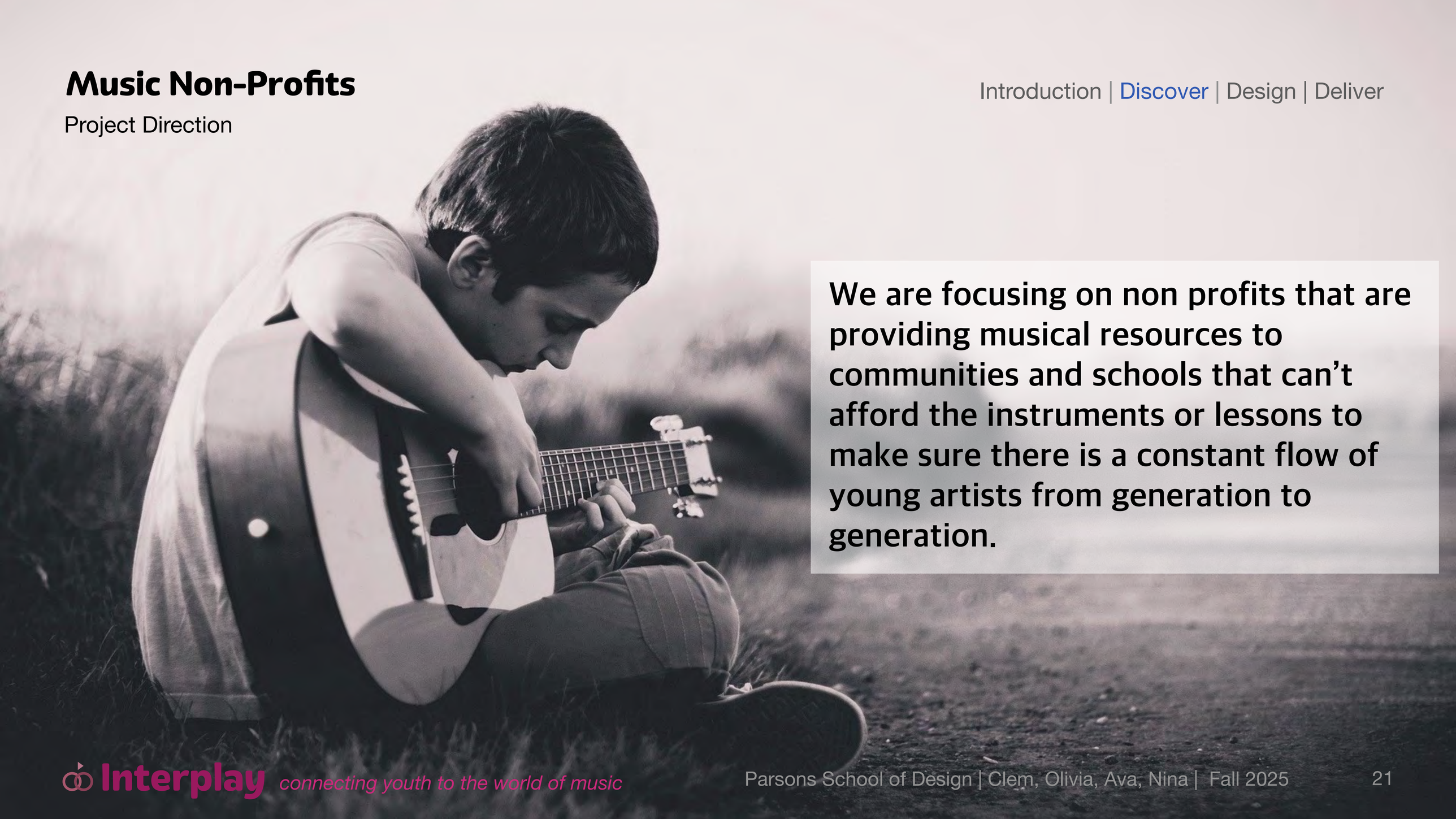
Why Music Is Important for Child Development

- Making music provides a **multi-sensory workout** for the brain (like playing sports vs. watching)
- **Improves hearing:** Musicians detect smaller sound differences, making speech and music easier to understand.
- **Strengthens motor and sensory areas:** Brain regions controlling fingers, hands, mouth, etc., grow with practice.
- **Boosts emotional and social skills:** Playing music with others improves communication and emotional expression.
- **Supports literacy:** Music training is linked to better reading comprehension and pattern recognition.
- **Enhances memory:** Music is deeply tied to long-term memories, especially later in life.



Music Non-Profits

Project Direction



We are focusing on non profits that are providing musical resources to communities and schools that can’t afford the instruments or lessons to make sure there is a constant flow of young artists from generation to generation.

Problem Statement

Music education builds **confidence** and **empowers young people** across New York City. However, access remains unequal, shaped by zip code and funding. While **NYC's music industry generates $5 billion in wages**, the educational pipeline is fragmented. **Schools** in under-resourced areas often **lack essential resources, including instruments, trained teachers, and consistent programming.** Federal policies like No Child Left Behind squeezed arts programs, and although the Every Student Succeeds Act reframed music as “well-rounded education," gaps remain. Students in neighborhoods with limited resources miss opportunities to develop creativity, widening educational disparities.

Organizations like **Save The Music Foundation, Jazz House Kids, and the Weill Music Institute** provide instruments and **mentorship to students**. Programs like the BIC Creativity Camp boost confidence, while Jazz House NYC offers training with instrument loans. Yet **impact remains limited by short-term formats, invite-only structures,** Manhattan locations, and grant reliance. Most **nonprofits work independently** without year-round school partnerships, creating inconsistent access. The **funding model is fragile**, raising questions about sustainability.

This research reveals an **opportunity to create a coordinated network connecting nonprofits with schools across boroughs for year-round education**. Instrument sharing systems would increase access without duplicates. Outcome frameworks tracking progression would secure long-term funding. **Pathways connecting students to professional opportunities through residencies and mentorship** demonstrate real impact. **Post-pandemic recovery and NYC's talent make this the right moment to transform** fragmented efforts into sustainable infrastructure reaching underserved neighborhoods.

Music History Timeline

1833

First public school music program introduced in Boston (model for NYC later).

1904

The Juilliard School precursor was founded in NYC (Institute of Musical Art).

1917

NYC Board of Education establishes music supervisors.

1936

Federal Music Project (New Deal) supports community music in NYC.

1965

Elementary and Secondary Education Act (ESEA) passes, increasing arts funding.

1969

Carnegie Hall opens Education Department (later Weill Music Institute).

1980s

Budget cuts reduce NYC music education access.

1997

VH1 Save The Music Foundation launches, restoring programs nationwide (impacting NYC schools).

1997

Jazz at Lincoln Center expands its education programs.

2001

No Child Left Behind Act (NCLB) emphasizes testing; arts programs are squeezed.

2003

Carnegie Hall launches Weill Music Institute as major nonprofit hub.

2015

Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) names music as part of a “well-rounded education.”

2022

NYC Department of Education Launches New Arts Expansion Initiatives post-pandemic.

Case Studies



BIC Creativity Camp



Creatives Rebuild New York



PlayUSA

Case Studies

BIC Creativity Camp

The BIC Creativity Camp, hosted by Save The Music in partnership with Charlie Puth, invited NYC-area high school students and teachers from schools receiving Music Technology grants to participate in creative workshops. The camp blended music production, writing, and visual design activities, giving students hands-on experience and direct mentorship from Puth while promoting creativity and collaboration.

The event successfully inspired students, boosted confidence, and brought attention to the importance of music education in NYC. However, its short-term and invite-only format limited broader access and long-lasting impact.



Case Studies

Jazz House Kids

Jazz House Kids launched Page One @ Jazz House NYC, a program for students to learn and play jazz. Hosted at Trinity Commons in Lower Manhattan, the program offers beginner and advanced tracks, ensemble classes, and instrument loans to make jazz education accessible. The partnership with Trinity Church also expanded opportunities for local youth through public concerts and workshops.

The program provides high-quality jazz training and community engagement, helping students build confidence, creativity, and collaboration skills. However, the program's reliance on grants and donated instruments has raised questions about long-term sustainability.



Case Studies

PlayUSA - Carnegie Hall's Weill Music

PlayUSA is Carnegie Hall's Weill Music Institute program that funds and supports community organizations offering equitable K-12 instrumental music education. In 2023-24 it awarded $500,000 in grants to 22 programs across 16 states, alongside consultation from Carnegie Hall staff, teacher professional development, online



Non-Profits

education through MUSIC

Midori & Friends
Making Music Building Futures

Save The Music FOUNDATION

upbeat NYC

CIRCLE IN THE SQUARE THEATRE SCHOOL

NEWMUSIC USA

Non-Profits

Education Through Music

Mission: To positively impact the **motivation**, **achievement**, and **self-confidence** of **underserved students** by integrating **music education** into the core curriculum of under-resourced schools.



Non-Profits

Midori & Friends

Mission: Midori & Friends harnesses the power of **music** to transform the lives of **children** and enrich their communities. Through **accessible music education programs**, Midori & Friends cultivates a **joy of learning, a spirit of service, and courageous self-expression** for all, illuminating pathways to a brighter future.



Non-Profits

Save the Music Foundation

Mission: to help **students, schools, and communities** reach their full potential through the power of **making music**. As one of the nation's leading nonprofit foundations for **music education**, Save the Music Foundation helped **over 2,800 schools** start and sustain their music programs.



Non-Profits

Up Beat NYC

Mission: to build **equity, opportunity, and community** through **free music education** and **ensemble performance** and to bring about positive change in the lives of **South Bronx children** and **youth**.



Non-Profits

Circle in the Square Theatre School

Mission: training connects emotional truth with the power of imagination, **cultivating artists** with strong technique who will be prepared to thrive in all **storytelling platforms**. We commit to an inclusive, diverse curriculum and culture, honoring our students' uniqueness while challenging them to expand their perspectives and **advance their craft**.

CIRCLE IN THE SQUARE THEATRE SCHOOL

Non-Profits

Inside Broadway

Mission: We nurture a **vibrant** and **inclusive community** for **artists and listeners** by supporting the **creation, performance, and appreciation of new music** throughout the United States.



Interviews

Expert/Non-Expert

Education Through Music - Jameon Moss (Director of Programs)

Midori & Friends - Larisa Gelman (Executive Director)

Save the Music Foundation - Rebecca Hof (Director, Teacher Programs)

UpBeat NYC - Laura Hutton (Teacher)

Inside Broadway - Sebastián Arroyo (Actor, teacher & DJ)

Circle in the Square Theatre School - Jeanne Slater (Artistic Director)



Interviews

Interviewee Questions

1. How does your non-profit ensure equitable access to music education across public schools with varying resource levels?
2. What operational challenges do you face when integrating music programs into schools that have limited infrastructure or funding?
3. How does Midori & Friends measure the long-term impact of its programs on students' personal and academic growth?
4. What strategies have proven most effective in maintaining partnerships with NYC schools and local artists?
5. How does Save the Music Foundation support and empower music teachers after instruments and resources are donated?
6. What trends have you noticed in how music education influences student engagement and school culture?
7. From your experience teaching at UpBeat NYC, how does collective music-making impact students' confidence and social skills?
8. What are the main challenges and rewards of teaching music in a community-based, free-of-charge program?
9. How does the school balance professional performance training with cultivating creative expression and individuality in students?
10. What do you think distinguishes your approach to arts education from other theatre programs in New York?

Interviews

Kenny Roby

About: Kenny Roby is a North Carolina-based singer-songwriter known for his work with Six String Drag and his solo career blending rock, soul, and gospel influences. His musical journey began at home rather than in school, shaped by a creative family environment and early exposure to instruments and performance. Kenny's story reflects an authentic, community-driven path into music, grounded in mentorship, collaboration, and lived experience rather than formal training. His background offers a real-world lens on how musicians often grow through access, support, and informal opportunities.

Interview Insights: Kenny's background shows that musical identity forms long before formal education and relies on early access, mentorship, and community rather than structured school programs. His experience growing up in a musical household, supported by family and informal networks, highlights the importance of making instruments, role models, and creative spaces easily accessible to young people. He reinforces that the biggest barriers are not talent but access, belonging, and opportunities to explore music socially. These insights point us toward designing interventions that prioritize early exposure, community connection, and low-pressure, informal pathways into music.



Interviews

Matt Keating

About: Matt is a multi-instrumentalist, songwriter, producer, and independent music teacher with a career spanning decades in bands, solo projects, and international touring. He discovered music early, shaped more by family, emotion, and community than by school programs. Self-taught for most of his life, he later pursued formal training as an adult, which shaped his teaching philosophy: music should feel joyful, intuitive, and expressive. Today, he teaches students of all ages, especially adults recovering from rigid or harmful early music experiences, and advocates for accessible, communal, and human-centered approaches to music learning.

Interview Insights: Matt's experiences show that intuitive, play-based learning is what truly sustains a lifelong connection to music. He grew up learning informally through family, friends, and self-teaching, and he believes traditional music education often causes harm through early pressure, rigid technique, and poor-quality instruments. For Matt, kids need access to good instruments, space to experiment, and teachers who keep music playful rather than mechanical. He sees music as a communal human need, not a talent filter, and believes that removing fear, judgment, and formality is the most effective way to help young people build confidence, express themselves, and stay connected to music. throughout their lives.



Interviews

Scott Winship, Director of Grants, New Music USA

About: Scott Winship is a musician, composer, and arts administrator with a background in music education and composition. His early career included roles at the Mid American Center for Contemporary Music and the American Music Center, where he supported fundraising and grant reporting. He later worked in a Chicago nonprofit focused on music education in underserved communities before returning to New York to join Meet the Composer. Following its 2011 merger with the American Music Center, Scott became Director of Grants at New Music USA, overseeing national programs that support composers, ensembles, and new music organizations.

Interview Insights: Scott emphasized that music has profound social and emotional benefits, especially for young people facing instability or stress. He highlighted that many organizations funded by New Music USA integrate mentorship, youth engagement, and education into their missions—even though the organization itself no longer runs a direct education program. He also stressed the importance of recording opportunities, composer visibility, and professional networks, noting that mentorship and relationship-building are essential for emerging artists. Overall, he sees music as a tool for connection, healing, and long-term creative development.



Personas

Maya – The Curious Creative

Age: 10

Grade: 5th Grade, NYC Public School (Bronx)

Background: Maya lives with her mom and older brother in a two-bedroom apartment. Maya loves to draw, sing along to pop songs on YouTube, and help her brother edit short videos for TikTok.

Personality & Interests: Inquisitive, shy at first, but opens up through creative activities. She's more confident expressing herself through visuals and sound than in more academic methods.

Needs & Challenges: Her school's music program only meets once a week, and they share instruments between classes. She doesn't have any music programs outside of school. Her family can't afford lessons or instruments.

How Music Nonprofits Help: Programs like *VH1 Save The Music* or *Harmony Program* could give her consistent access to instruments, hands-on workshops, or small ensembles that build her confidence. Even if she doesn't pursue music professionally, these programs give her focus, belonging, and emotional expression she struggles to find in academic subjects.



Personas

Jayden – The STEM Dreamer

Age: 13

Grade: 8th Grade, NYC Public School (Queens)

Background: Jayden lives with immigrant parents. He excels in math and coding and spends most of his free time building in Roblox Studio or watching YouTube tutorials. He used to play the recorder in 4th grade, but hasn't had music since.

Personality & Interests: Analytical, curious, social in small groups. Jayden is not particularly drawn to performing arts but enjoys rhythm-based games and experimenting with sound design.

Needs & Challenges: Jayden's middle school has limited creative electives, and he spends long days in test prep programs. He misses hands-on, creative outlets.

How Music Nonprofits Help: Programs like *Carnegie Hall's Weill Music Institute* or *Jazz at Lincoln Center's youth workshops* could reintroduce him to music through digital composition or technology-based projects, connecting his STEM interests to creativity. Access to music could improve his focus, reduce stress, and develop teamwork and communication skills often left out of test-heavy environments.



Personas

Ms. Brooks – The Overextended Educator

Age: 34

Role: Middle School Music Teacher, Brooklyn

Background: Ms. Brooks teaches 6th–8th grade general music and choir at a Title I public school. She's passionate about making music accessible to everyone. She manages 150 students weekly with limited equipment.

Personality & Interests: Energetic, resourceful, often improvises to keep lessons engaging. Loves jazz and community theater but feels creatively drained from administrative demands.

Needs & Challenges: Her budget barely covers sheet music and basic repairs. She wants professional development in culturally responsive music teaching and digital composition tools, but lacks time and funding.

How Music Nonprofits Help: Grants or partnerships from *VH1 Save The Music, Carnegie Hall's Education Program,* or *NYC Arts in Education Roundtable* could supply instruments, new curricula, or teacher training. Support would help her sustain music in a school system where the arts are often first to be cut, empowering her to give students creative skills that reach beyond the classroom.



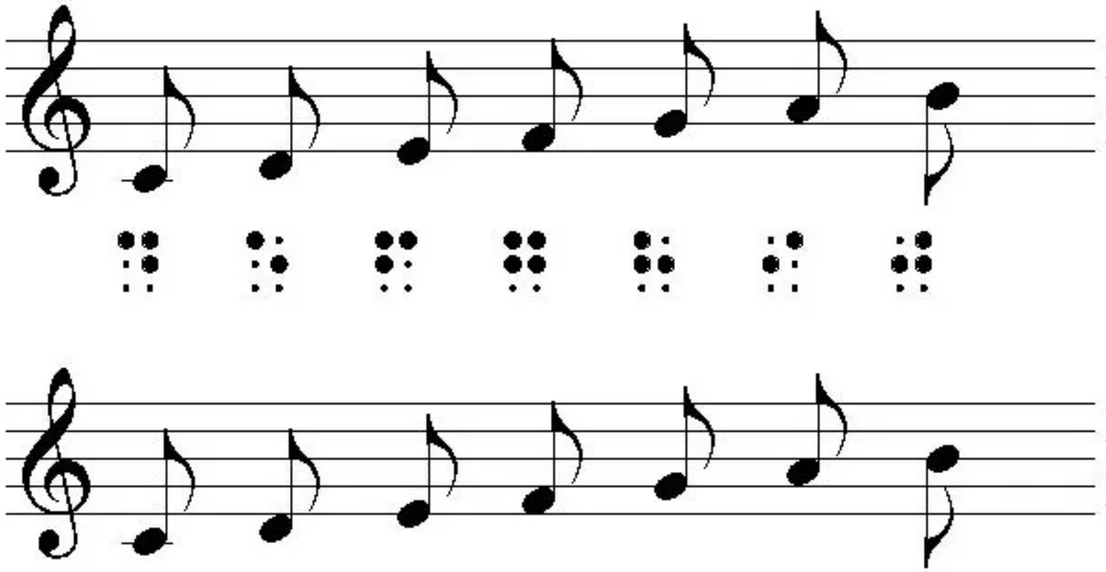
Design Criteria

Our Design Criteria guide how decisions were made and refined throughout the project. Each reflects Interplay's mission to expand access to music education across NYC.

Accessibility – Ensure that music education and resources are inclusive and available across boroughs, regardless of income or school funding.

Sustainability – Develop a system that supports long-term collaboration between nonprofits, schools, and artists beyond one-time programs.

Collaboration – Center partnerships between organizations, educators, and youth to strengthen community and cultural connections.



Interplay x New Music USA

Collaboration

Overview: Interplay is partnering with New Music USA to **strengthen music education access**, creative development, and artist support across New York City. Through our interview with Scott Winship, Director of Grants, we learned how deeply New Music USA prioritizes mentorship, community-centered creativity, and opportunities that keep young people connected to music.

To address gaps in access and support, we developed **three key interventions:**

1. New Music Education Access Grant
A micro-grant supporting young musicians who lack access to instruments, lessons, or music programs.

2. New Music USA Mentorship
A mentorship pathway pairing emerging musicians with experienced composers and artists in New Music USA's network.

3. New Music USA Practice Rooms

Opening unused rooms at Parsons as free or low-cost practice and lesson spaces for young musicians.

New Music USA Grant

Grant Application

New Music USA Mentorship

Course Catalog



THE NEW SCHOOL

About the Course Catalog

COURSE CATALOG

CAPR 6991

NEW MUSIC USA MENTORSHIP

COLLEGE OF PERFORMING ARTS: MANNES

Graduate Course

Majors Only

NEW MUSIC USA MENTORSHIP
SPRING 2026

TAUGHT BY: ROBERT RABINOVITZ

SECTION: A

CRN: 1073

Credits: 0 TO 3

The New Music USA Mentorship program provides New School students with the opportunity to receive credit for professional training in music education, mentorship, and community engagement. Students enrolled in this course will serve as mentors and tutors for individuals in the New York City community who are interested in taking music lessons. While mentor roles are open only to eligible New School students, participation as a mentee is open to any learner seeking musical support, and the program is promoted widely through New Music USA.

NEW MUSIC USA MENTORSHIP
SUMMER 2026

TAUGHT BY: ROBERT RABINOVITZ

SECTION: A

CRN: 1007

Credits: 0 TO 3

The New Music USA Mentorship program provides New School students with the opportunity to receive credit for professional training in music education, mentorship, and community engagement. Students enrolled in this course will serve as mentors and tutors for individuals in the New York City community who are interested in taking music lessons. While mentor roles are open only to eligible New School students, participation as a mentee is open to any learner seeking musical support, and the program is promoted widely through New Music USA.

NEW MUSIC USA MENTORSHIP
FALL 2026

TAUGHT BY: ROBERT RABINOVITZ

SECTION: A

CRN: 1554

Credits: 0 TO 3

The New Music USA Mentorship program provides New School students with the opportunity to receive credit for professional training in music education, mentorship, and community engagement. Students enrolled in this course will serve as mentors and tutors for individuals in the New York City community who are interested in taking music lessons. While mentor roles are open only to eligible New School students, participation as a mentee is open to any learner seeking musical support, and the program is promoted widely through New Music USA.

New Music USA Practice Rooms





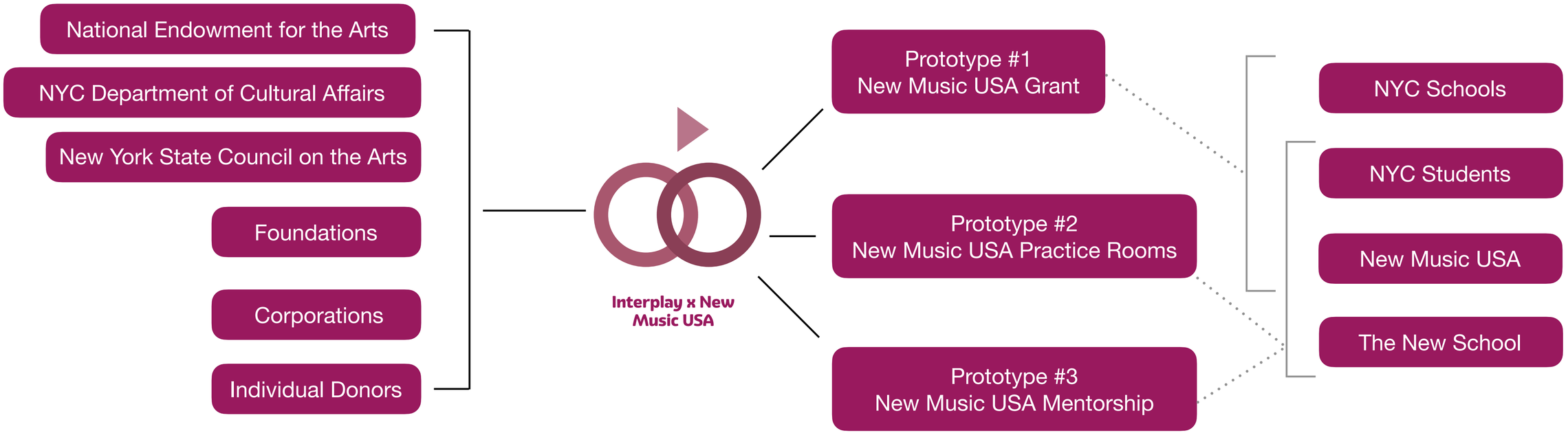
Mascot





Intervention Points

Systems Map



Business Plan

Key Partnerships

- New Music USA
- NYC Department of Cultural Affairs
- New York State Council on the Arts
- National Endowment for the Arts
- Teaching artists & music educators
- The New School (Parsons/Mannes)
- Community schools & youth programs
- Philanthropic donors + arts foundations
- Government arts agencies (NEA)

Key Activities

- Research + ecosystem mapping
- Coordinating schools, artists, and nonprofits
- Facilitating micro-grants
- Collecting feedback + measuring impact

Key Resources

- Practice-room space at The New School
- Funding from grants, donors, foundations, and public agencies
- Scheduling tools, communication platforms, and research frameworks

Value Propositions

- **For Students:** Accessible, consistent music learning, practice, and mentorship
- **For Schools:** Simple, low-barrier support for music programming
- **For Teaching Artists:** Paid opportunities + structured community engagement
- **For New Music USA:** Expanded reach, clearer impact pathways, stronger music-education ecosystem
- **For NYC:** A stronger pipeline of young musicians and cultural participation

Customer Relationships

- Long-term partnerships with NYC schools
- Supportive, community-centered relationship with teaching artists
- Collaborative design and feedback loops with New Music USA

Channels

- The New School / Parsons / Mannes partnerships
- In-person workshops, mentorship, and on-site programming
- Digital communication (email, platforms, scheduling)

Customer Segments

- Primary: NYC Students (K–12)
- Secondary: NYC Schools + after-school programs
- New Music USA + wider music nonprofit community
- Teaching artists and emerging musicians
- Local communities benefiting from arts access.

Cost Structure

- Payment for teaching artists
- Grant funding disbursement (grants)
- Technology (scheduling platform, communication tools)
- Space management + operations
- Program coordination + administrative time

Revenue Streams

- Philanthropic grants (Creative Capital, Mellon, Ford, etc.)
- Government arts funding (NEA, NYC DCLA, DOE arts programs)
- Donations from individuals + music supporters
- Corporate sponsorships (music brands, tech companies)
- University funding / community-engagement funds from The New School

Interplay x New Music USA

When access expands, talent emerges and entire communities begin to sound different.

Space + mentorship = sustainable pathways for NYC youth.

This intervention transforms music education from fragmented to interconnected, a living system that grows with the city.

Appendix

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